

Rahim Merchant

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EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

Honors Bachelor's Degree, Computing and Financial Management

Waterloo, ON

September 2022 – Present

EXPERIENCE

BDC Capital

Venture Capital and Investment Analyst Intern

May 2025 - August 2025

- Sourced and evaluated **100+ pitch decks** and conducted **15+ founder calls** to assess **thesis fit** and build the early-stage pipeline of **climate** and **deep tech** startups for **BDC's \$150M Sustainability Venture Fund**.
- Conducted due diligence on **3+ companies**, from reverse logistics platform to AI chip startup; produced **competitive landscape reports**, conducted **founder interviews**, and mapped **potential acquirers** to support **IC memos**.
- Built detailed **financial models**—including **DCF**s, **public/private comps**, **cap tables**, and **exit returns scenarios**—to assess valuation and investor outcomes, informing diligence and **fund-level return projections**.
- Developed an internal **Python-based sourcing tool** using **NLP** to evaluate thesis fit across **1,000+ companies**, streamlining **deal triage** and saving the team **30+ minutes per day**.

Alcohol and Gaming Commission of Ontario

Data and Analytics Intern

September 2024 - December 2024

- Optimized **ETL pipelines** using **Python**, **SQL**, and **PySpark** in **Azure Synapse**, reducing data processing time by **40%** through **query optimization** and **parallel processing**.
- Developed automated **Power BI dashboards** to visualize **KPIs** and **trends**, replacing manual reporting and saving cross-functional teams **30+ minutes per day**.

Fallyx

Venture Strategy and Market Research Intern

June 2024 - August 2024

- Led **market research** on senior care tech, analyzing **15+ competitors** to identify **3+ key market gaps**, shaping Fallyx's **go-to-market strategy**.
- Designed **investor pitch decks**, refining key messaging and business narratives to support **internal strategy discussions**.
- Developed **financial models** comparing **10+ competitors**, analyzing key **valuation metrics** to inform strategic decision-making.

Environment and Climate Change Canada

Data Analyst Intern

January 2024 – April 2024

- Built and optimized **Power BI dashboards** using **DAX** and **Power Query**, improving data access by **30%** and boosting user engagement through **A/B testing** of design layouts.
- Automated **ETL pipelines** in **Microsoft Azure**, reducing manual processing time by **40%** and accelerating real-time **Power BI** reporting for stakeholders.

PROJECTS

InnSight

Co-Founder — Hotel Camera Analytics Startup

April 2024 – Feb 2025

- Validated market demand by interviewing **20+ hotel managers**, uncovering key pain points in security and operations that led to a successful **pilot launch** at a partner hotel.
- Built a full-stack MVP using **OpenCV**, **PyTorch**, and **Twilio** to deliver real-time alerts for security risks and long queues; deployed a web platform on **AWS EC2** with **MongoDB** backend.
- Placed **top 8 of 80+ teams** in the **Waterloo Velocity \$5K Pitch Competition**, showcasing product-market fit through compelling pitch decks and storytelling.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, MySQL, C/C++, JavaScript, R, Racket, HTML, CSS, Go
- **Frameworks/Tools:** Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Scikit-learn, Tableau, Power BI, TensorFlow, React, Flask, Git, Node.js, Express, PyTorch, PySpark, OpenCV, YOLO, Streamlit, Docker, Postman, Figma, AWS, Azure, MongoDB, Docker, Bash